

specialised processes and sharper understanding of changing consumer preferences. “In many ways, this can also mirror India’s broader manufacturing evolution, from scale-led production towards value-added, innovation-driven manufacturing that is better equipped to compete globally,” adds Gupta.

It is impossible to miss the talk on moving up the value chain, a constant in today’s manufacturing lexicon. To most people, it’s about more sophisticated products. Berger Paints’ Roy insists it means creating greater value through design, innovation, knowledge, sustainability, consistency and service.

“Increasingly, customers are buying complete solutions rather than just products and that is an area where Indian companies can differentiate themselves,” he says.

124 | In the case of his industry, the expectation is not just a can of paint but products that can solve problems alongside technical support and consistency.

THE LEADERSHIP ZONE

Not only is India unique for multiple reasons, it also has a strange advantage—it cannot pick a success from another market and move it here. The copy and paste model is a recipe for disaster, as many companies have learnt. How can one create a model that must gain scale in its own, indigenous way? Here is what some multinationals say.

Santosh Iyer, MD & CEO of Mercedes-Benz India, says that for Indian manufacturing to go global and attain leadership, it is essential to leverage free-trade agreements and an open economy with no trade barriers. “India’s favourable demographics, resource base and diverse talent pool need to be made future-ready. Our workforce

MAJOR MANUFACTURING CLUSTERS

